B.2 Installing pact-js

When you install Node, it also comes with npm, which is a tool that is commonly used to manage and share JavaScript packages or libraries. You can think of npm similar to a big supermarket that contains different products for your needs. Each package in npm is like a product on the supermarket shelf, which has a unique name and barcode. When you find a package, you can add it to your shopping cart and check out. This is equivalent to the following command:

```
npm install “PACKAGE_NAME”
```

In a supermarket, you need to have a trolley (in the US, a shopping cart) to put your items in, especially if you need to get a lot of products. It’s similar to JavaScript projects that you want to start locally; you need a folder to put the packages in that you’re going to get. Before we install pact-js, we need to initialize our project directory, especially if you haven’t created any existing projects. To do this, go to your terminal of choice, and type in the following commands:

```
mkdir pact-js-project
cd pact-js-project
```

This creates a brand-new folder called pact-js-project. In the same folder, let’s also initialize npm by typing in the following command:

```
npm init -y
```

You should see a file, package.json, which contains a similar output to the following:

```
{
  "name": "pact-js-project",
  "version": "1.0.0",
  "description": "",
  "main": "index.js",
  "scripts": {
    "test": "echo \"Error: no test specified\" && exit 1"
  },
  "keywords": [],
  "author": "",
  "license": "ISC"
}
```